

Physical Activity for Lifelong Health: How Much You Need and How to Start Safely

FRONT MATTER

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Physical Activity for Lifelong Health: How Much You Need and How to Start Safely

CHAPTER 1

Learning Objectives

By the end of this interactive lesson, you will be able to:

1. Explain the basic physical activity targets for adults, children, and adolescents.
2. Tell the difference between moderate and vigorous activity using practical cues like the talk test.
3. Identify examples of aerobic, muscle-strengthening, and bone-strengthening activities.
4. Create a realistic weekly activity plan that fits your ability, schedule, health needs, and environment.
5. Recognize warning symptoms that mean you should stop activity and seek medical guidance.
6. Apply the memory formula: Move most days, strengthen twice weekly, start small, progress gradually.

CHAPTER 2

Opening Hook: The Health Habit That Compounds

You do not need to become an athlete to gain real health benefits

from physical activity.

A short walk, a few strength exercises, dancing in your living room, gardening, pushing a stroller, rolling your wheelchair, taking the stairs, or doing chair-based movement can all count.

The key is consistency.

> Memory Formula™:

> Move most days, strengthen twice weekly, start small, progress gradually.

This lesson will help you understand how much activity is recommended, how to tell whether your effort is moderate or vigorous, how to choose safe activities, and how to build a weekly plan that works in real life.

CHAPTER 3

Important Safety Note

General physical activity targets are helpful, but they are not a personal medical prescription.

Your safest starting point depends on factors such as:

- Current fitness level

- Age

- Pregnancy or postpartum status

- Disability or mobility needs

- Injury or pain

- Heart, lung, metabolic, neurological, or joint conditions

- Medications that affect heart rate, balance, blood pressure, or

blood sugar

Recent surgery, illness, or hospitalization

If you have a chronic condition, are pregnant or recently postpartum, have symptoms with activity, or are unsure what is safe for you, speak with a qualified healthcare professional before beginning or increasing activity.

1. Simple Answer: How Much Physical Activity Do You Need?

CHAPTER 4

Adults

For most adults, the general weekly target is:

150–300 minutes per week of moderate-intensity aerobic activity, or

75–150 minutes per week of vigorous-intensity aerobic activity, or

An equivalent combination of moderate and vigorous activity
plus

Muscle-strengthening activities at least 2 days per week

Adults should also:

Reduce sedentary time

Break up long periods of sitting when possible

Accumulate activity in shorter sessions throughout the week

You do not have to complete long workouts for activity to count.

Several shorter sessions can add up.

Examples:

Three 10-minute walks in one day

A 15-minute morning walk plus 15 minutes of evening cycling

Five 30-minute sessions across the week

Ten-minute movement breaks during work or caregiving routines

> Remember: Move most days, strengthen twice weekly, start small, progress gradually.

CHAPTER 5

Children and Adolescents Ages 6–17

The general goal for children and teens is:

An average of at least 60 minutes per day of moderate-to-vigorous physical activity

This should include:

Vigorous activity at least 3 days per week

Muscle-strengthening activity at least 3 days per week

Bone-strengthening activity at least 3 days per week

Children do not need formal workouts. Play, sports, active transportation, playground time, dancing, running games, climbing, and jumping activities can all count.

CHAPTER 6

Inactive Beginners

If you are inactive, the most important message is:

> Some physical activity is better than none. Health benefits begin even below the full guideline amounts.

You do not need to reach the full target immediately. Begin where you are.

A safe starting point may be:

- 5 minutes of walking
- 3 minutes of chair movement
- One light strength exercise
- Gentle mobility work
- One short movement break per day

Then build gradually.

CHAPTER 7

Learner Checkpoint

Before moving on, complete this sentence:

> My first realistic movement step could be:

>

Examples:

“Walk for 5 minutes after lunch.”

“Do chair exercises during one TV break.”

“Take a short movement break every afternoon.”

“Try one beginner strength routine twice this week.”

2. QRU Translation™

Physical activity is one of the most powerful daily habits for long-term health.

For adults, the basic target is regular aerobic movement such as walking, cycling, swimming, dancing, wheelchair propulsion, or active chores, combined with strengthening work at least twice each week.

For children and teens, growing bodies need frequent movement. The target is higher: about an hour a day on average, with a mix of activities that raise the heart rate, strengthen muscles, and load the bones in healthy ways.

If you are inactive, recovering from injury, pregnant, older, disabled, or living with a chronic condition, the goal is not to “push through.” The goal is to choose appropriate movement, start small, progress gradually, and seek medical guidance when symptoms or health concerns suggest it is needed.

> QRU Translation:

> Do not wait for the perfect workout. Build a movement habit that fits your real life and your real body.

3. Memory Formula™

> Move most days, strengthen twice weekly, start small, progress gradually.

Use this as your simple lifelong health formula:

Formula Step What It Means Practical Example

Move most days Build regular aerobic activity into your week.

Walk, roll, cycle, swim, dance, garden, or do active chores.

Strengthen twice weekly Train major muscle groups at least 2 days per week. Squats to a chair, wall push-ups, resistance bands, weights, or bodyweight exercises.

Start small Begin at a level your body can tolerate. 5–10 minutes, light effort, or fewer repetitions.

Progress gradually Increase time, frequency, or intensity step by step. Add 5 minutes, one extra day, or slightly more challenge over time.

CHAPTER 8

Quick Recall Prompt

Without looking back, fill in the blanks:

> Move most days, strengthen ____ weekly, start __, progress ____.

Answer: twice, small, gradually

4. Why Physical Activity Matters

Regular physical activity is linked with lower risk of:

Cardiovascular disease
Type 2 diabetes
Some cancers
Depression and anxiety symptoms
Cognitive decline
Falls and fall-related injuries
Premature death

It also supports:

Better sleep
Stronger bones and muscles
Improved balance and coordination
Healthier blood pressure and blood sugar control
Better mood and energy
Greater independence with daily activities

Physical activity is not only about athletic fitness. It is about helping your body, brain, and daily life function better over time.

CHAPTER 9

Everyday Analogy

Physical activity is like charging a battery.

Small, regular charges keep the whole system working better than waiting until the battery is nearly empty and trying to fix everything at once.

A 10-minute walk, a few chair exercises, a short dance break, or a gentle mobility routine may seem small, but repeated consistently, these “charges” add up.

- > Memory Reminder:
- > Move most days. Strengthen twice weekly. Start small. Progress gradually.

5. Moderate vs. Vigorous Activity

Physical activity intensity describes how hard your body is working.

The two most common intensity levels are:

Moderate intensity

Vigorous intensity

Both can improve health. The right choice depends on your current fitness, health history, preferences, and goals.

CHAPTER 10

Moderate-Intensity Activity

During moderate activity:

Your heart rate and breathing increase.

You can talk, but you may not want to sing.

You feel like you are working, but you are not near your maximum effort.

Examples may include:

Brisk walking

Easy cycling

Water aerobics

Dancing at a comfortable pace
Gardening or yard work
Doubles tennis
Active housework
Pushing a stroller at a steady pace
Wheelchair propulsion at a steady pace

CHAPTER 11

Vigorous-Intensity Activity

During vigorous activity:

Your heart rate and breathing increase a lot.
Talking becomes difficult.
You can say only a few words before needing to breathe.
The effort feels challenging.

Examples may include:

Running or jogging
Fast cycling
Swimming laps
Singles tennis
Hiking uphill
Jump rope
Fast dancing
High-intensity interval training, if appropriate
Competitive sports

Vigorous activity is not necessary for everyone, and it may not be the best starting point for beginners or people with certain health

conditions.

6. The Talk Test

The talk test is a practical way to estimate intensity without equipment.

If You Can... Your Intensity Is Likely...

Sing comfortably Light

Talk but not sing Moderate

Say only a few words at a time Vigorous

Barely speak or feel distressed Too intense; slow down or stop

CHAPTER 12

Knowledge Check 1

You are walking at a pace where you can speak in full sentences, but singing would be difficult.

What intensity is this most likely?

- A. Light
- B. Moderate
- C. Vigorous
- D. Too intense

Answer: B. Moderate

CHAPTER 13

Knowledge Check 2

You are cycling so hard that you can only say two or three words before needing to breathe.

What intensity is this most likely?

- A. Light
- B. Moderate
- C. Vigorous
- D. Sedentary

Answer: C. Vigorous

CHAPTER 14

Reflection Prompt

Think of one activity you already do or could realistically start.

Activity: _____

Using the talk test, this activity is usually:

- ☐ Light
- ☐ Moderate
- ☐ Vigorous
- ☐ It depends on my pace

7. Types of Physical Activity

A balanced activity routine usually includes three categories:

1. Aerobic activity
2. Muscle-strengthening activity
3. Bone-strengthening activity

Some activities fit more than one category.

CHAPTER 15

A. Aerobic Activity

Aerobic activity uses large muscle groups and raises your heart rate and breathing.

Examples:

Walking

Hiking

Cycling

Swimming

Dancing

Jogging or running

Rowing

Skating

Active games

Water aerobics

Wheelchair propulsion

Low-impact cardio videos

Sports such as basketball, soccer, tennis, or pickleball

Active chores such as raking leaves or mowing with a push mower

Aerobic activity is the main category used to meet the weekly

minute target for adults.

CHAPTER 16

B. Muscle-Strengthening Activity

Muscle-strengthening activity makes your muscles work against resistance.

Adults should aim for strengthening activities at least 2 days per week, involving major muscle groups such as:

- Legs
- Hips
- Back
- Chest
- Abdomen
- Shoulders
- Arms

Examples:

- Lifting weights
- Resistance band exercises
- Bodyweight exercises
- Wall push-ups
- Chair squats or sit-to-stands
- Step-ups
- Lunges, if appropriate
- Planks or modified planks
- Carrying groceries
- Heavy gardening

Climbing activities

Pilates-style strengthening

Wheelchair push-ups or seated resistance exercises

For beginners, strengthening does not need to be complicated. One set of 8–12 comfortable repetitions of a few exercises can be a starting point.

CHAPTER 17

C. Bone-Strengthening Activity

Bone-strengthening activities create healthy impact or loading forces on bones.

These are especially emphasized for children and adolescents, but adults may also benefit from appropriate bone-loading activities depending on health status and injury risk.

Examples for children and teens:

Jumping

Hopping

Skiping

Running

Basketball

Soccer

Gymnastics

Tennis

Jump rope

Playground climbing

Examples for adults, if appropriate:

Brisk walking

Stair climbing

Hiking

Dancing

Resistance training

Jogging or running, if joints and health status allow

Low-impact strength and balance work for those who should avoid jumping

People with osteoporosis, joint problems, balance issues, pregnancy-related concerns, or injury history should ask a healthcare professional which bone-strengthening activities are appropriate.

CHAPTER 18

Learner Checkpoint: Sort the Activity

Place each activity into one or more categories: aerobic, muscle-strengthening, bone-strengthening.

Activity	Aerobic	Muscle-Strengthening	Bone-Strengthening
----------	---------	----------------------	--------------------

Brisk walking	☐	☐	☐
---------------	--------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------

Resistance band rows	☐	☐	☐
----------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------

Jump rope	☐	☐	☐
-----------	--------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------

Swimming laps	☐	☐	☐
---------------	--------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------

Chair sit-to-stands	☐	☐	☐
---------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------

Dancing	☐	☐	☐
---------	--------------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------

18.1 Suggested Answers

Activity Likely Category

Brisk walking Aerobic; may provide some bone-loading

Resistance band rows Muscle-strengthening

Jump rope Aerobic and bone-strengthening

Swimming laps Aerobic

Chair sit-to-stands Muscle-strengthening

Dancing Aerobic; may be bone-strengthening depending on style

8. Reducing Sedentary Time

Physical activity is important, but so is reducing long periods of sitting or inactivity.

Sedentary time includes:

- Sitting at a desk for long periods

- Watching TV for hours without movement

- Long car rides

- Extended screen time

- Sitting or lying down for most of the day while awake

You do not have to eliminate sitting. Instead, look for small ways to interrupt it.

Examples:

- Stand or move for 1–3 minutes every 30–60 minutes.

- Walk during phone calls.

- Stretch during TV breaks.

- Do chair marches or ankle circles.

- Park farther away if safe and practical.

- Take one extra trip up the stairs.

Use a reminder alarm for movement breaks.

> Memory Reminder:

> Move most days does not only mean planned workouts. It also means adding movement into ordinary days.

CHAPTER 19

Mini Challenge

Choose one sedentary-time breaker to try this week:

☐ Stand or move during TV commercials

☐ Take a 2-minute walking break every hour

☐ Stretch after long periods of sitting

☐ Walk during one phone call per day

☐ Do chair exercises once daily

☐ Other: _____

9. How to Start Safely

A safe start is usually:

Realistic

Comfortable

Gradual

Adapted to your body

Flexible enough for real life

CHAPTER 20

Start-Small Options

If you are new to activity, try one of these:

- Walk for 5 minutes, 3 days this week.
- Do 5 chair sit-to-stands, 2 days this week.
- Stretch gently for 5 minutes after waking.
- Do 3 short movement breaks during the day.
- Try a beginner seated workout.
- Dance to one song.
- Walk indoors during bad weather.
- Use resistance bands for one upper-body exercise.

The first goal is not perfection. The first goal is consistency.

10. Progress Gradually

Avoid increasing everything at once.

You can progress by changing one variable at a time:

1. Duration — how long you move
2. Frequency — how often you move
3. Intensity — how hard you move

A practical progression rule:

> Increase duration, frequency, or intensity gradually — not all at once.

CHAPTER 21

Example: Gradual Walking Progression

Week Plan

- Week 1 Walk 5–10 minutes, 3 days
- Week 2 Walk 10 minutes, 4 days
- Week 3 Walk 15 minutes, 4 days
- Week 4 Walk 20 minutes, 4 days
- Week 5 Add one slightly brisk interval if appropriate

If soreness, fatigue, pain, or symptoms increase, reduce the plan and progress more slowly.

CHAPTER 22

Knowledge Check 3

Which progression is usually safest?

- A. Increase from 0 minutes to 60 minutes daily immediately.
- B. Add more time, more days, and harder intensity all in the same week.
- C. Start small and gradually increase one part of the plan at a time.
- D. Ignore pain and push through.

Answer: C. Start small and gradually increase one part of the plan at a time.

11. Adapted Options for Real Life

Physical activity should be adaptable. The goal is not to force one version of exercise onto every person.

The goal is to find movement that is safe, realistic, and beneficial for your situation.

CHAPTER 23

Beginners

Try:

- 5–10 minute walks
- Chair exercises
- Gentle mobility routines
- Beginner strength exercises
- One short movement break per day
- Low-impact videos
- Light household tasks

Focus on:

- > Start small. Progress gradually.

CHAPTER 24

Older Adults

Older adults benefit from aerobic activity, strengthening, and balance work when appropriate.

Options may include:

- Walking
- Water exercise
- Chair yoga
- Tai chi
- Sit-to-stands
- Resistance bands
- Balance practice near a stable surface

Light gardening

Supervised exercise programs

Older adults with fall risk, osteoporosis, dizziness, or major health conditions should seek guidance about safe activities.

CHAPTER 25

People With Disabilities

Adapt activity to your body, equipment, environment, and support needs.

Options may include:

Seated cardio

Wheelchair propulsion

Resistance bands

Adaptive sports

Pool-based movement

Range-of-motion exercises

Hand cycling

Supported standing or balance work, if appropriate

Physical or occupational therapy-guided programs

Intensity can still be monitored with the talk test, perceived effort, breathing, and symptom awareness.

CHAPTER 26

Pregnancy and Postpartum

Many people can benefit from physical activity during pregnancy and postpartum, but safety depends on individual health, pregnancy status, delivery recovery, symptoms, and medical guidance.

Options may include:

- Walking

- Prenatal or postpartum exercise programs

- Gentle strengthening

- Pelvic floor exercises when appropriate

- Swimming or water exercise

- Mobility work

- Modified yoga

Seek medical guidance before starting or continuing activity if you have pregnancy complications, concerning symptoms, or restrictions from your healthcare professional.

Stop activity and seek medical advice for warning signs such as chest pain, dizziness, fainting, vaginal bleeding, fluid leakage, regular painful contractions, calf swelling or pain, severe headache, or shortness of breath before exertion.

CHAPTER 27

Chronic Conditions

People with chronic conditions often benefit from activity, but the plan may need adjustment.

Examples of conditions that may require individualized guidance include:

Heart disease
Diabetes
Asthma or COPD
Arthritis
Osteoporosis
Neurological conditions
Cancer treatment or recovery
Kidney disease
Chronic pain
High blood pressure
Balance disorders

Helpful adaptations may include:

Lower-intensity activity
Longer warm-ups and cool-downs
Monitoring blood sugar when relevant
Carrying rescue medication if prescribed
Avoiding extreme temperatures
Choosing low-impact options
Using supervised programs such as cardiac rehab, pulmonary rehab, physical therapy, or adapted exercise sessions

CHAPTER 28

Limited Space

Try:

Marching in place
Chair exercises

Wall push-ups
Resistance bands
Step-ups on a sturdy step
Dancing to one song
Balance practice near a stable surface
Short indoor walking loops

CHAPTER 29

Low Budget

Try:

Walking
Stair climbing
Bodyweight exercises
Free online beginner videos
Community recreation programs
Household items as light weights
Public parks
Resistance bands
Library fitness resources

You do not need expensive equipment to be active.

CHAPTER 30

Bad Weather

Try:

Indoor walking
Mall walking
Chair cardio
Dancing indoors
Low-impact video workouts
Resistance training
Stretching and mobility routines
Stair walking, if safe
Community centers or indoor pools

CHAPTER 31

Scenario Question 1

Maria has not exercised in years. She wants to improve her health but feels overwhelmed. Which plan is the best starting point?

- A. Run 45 minutes every day starting tomorrow.
- B. Walk 5–10 minutes three times this week and add gradually.
- C. Do a very intense workout until she is exhausted.
- D. Wait until she can afford a gym membership.

Best Answer: B. Walk 5–10 minutes three times this week and add gradually.

Why? Maria is starting small and progressing gradually.

CHAPTER 32

Scenario Question 2

Devin has a busy schedule and cannot find a 30-minute block for exercise. What could Devin do?

- A. Skip activity completely.
- B. Accumulate shorter sessions, such as three 10-minute walks.
- C. Only exercise if a full hour is available.
- D. Do vigorous activity without warming up.

Best Answer: B. Accumulate shorter sessions, such as three 10-minute walks.

Why? Activity can be accumulated in shorter sessions throughout the week.

CHAPTER 33

Scenario Question 3

A teen enjoys basketball, jumping games, and climbing at the playground. These activities can support which category?

- A. Bone-strengthening activity
- B. Sedentary behavior
- C. Only flexibility
- D. None of the above

Best Answer: A. Bone-strengthening activity

Why? Jumping, running, and climbing load bones in healthy ways for growing bodies.

12. Warning Symptoms: When to

Stop and Seek Medical Guidance

Physical activity should challenge you appropriately, but it should not cause dangerous symptoms.

Stop activity and seek medical advice if you experience:

- Chest pain, pressure, tightness, or discomfort
- Severe shortness of breath or shortness of breath that is unusual for you
- Fainting
- Feeling like you might faint
- Dizziness or lightheadedness
- Irregular, racing, or pounding heartbeat that feels unusual
- Severe or unusual pain
- New or worsening joint pain that changes how you move
- Severe headache
- Confusion
- Sudden weakness, numbness, or trouble speaking
- Calf pain, swelling, warmth, or redness
- Wheezing or breathing difficulty that does not improve with usual treatment
- Symptoms that do not resolve with rest
- Any symptom that feels alarming, unusual, or unsafe

If symptoms are severe, sudden, or suggest an emergency, seek urgent medical care.

Do not “push through” warning symptoms.

Safety Check Prompt

Which symptoms would make you stop activity and seek guidance?

Check all that apply:

- ☐ Chest pain
- ☐ Fainting
- ☐ Severe shortness of breath
- ☐ Dizziness
- ☐ Irregular heartbeat
- ☐ Unusual severe pain
- ☐ Symptoms that do not resolve with rest
- ☐ Mild muscle warmth during a normal warm-up

Correct Choices: All except mild muscle warmth during a normal warm-up.

13. Warm-Up, Cool-Down, and Recovery

A safe routine often includes:

CHAPTER 35

Warm-Up

Start with 5–10 minutes of easier movement.

Examples:

Slow walking before brisk walking
Gentle cycling before faster cycling
Shoulder rolls before upper-body exercise
Easy marching before dancing

CHAPTER 36

Cool-Down

End with a few minutes of easier movement.

Examples:

Slow your walking pace
Reduce cycling speed
Breathe slowly
Stretch gently if it feels good

CHAPTER 37

Recovery

Recovery matters, especially when beginning.

Helpful signs your plan may be appropriate:

You feel challenged but not crushed.
Normal mild soreness resolves within a day or two.
Energy and confidence improve over time.
You can continue daily responsibilities.

Signs you may need to reduce or modify activity:

Pain worsens
Fatigue is excessive

Soreness lasts several days
Symptoms appear during activity
You dread every session because it feels too hard

14. Sample Beginner Weekly Plan

This sample is for a generally healthy beginner. Modify based on your fitness level, medical history, symptoms, schedule, and professional guidance.

> Goal: Move most days, strengthen twice weekly, start small, progress gradually.

Day	Activity Plan	Intensity
Monday	10-minute walk or indoor walking	Light to moderate
Tuesday	Beginner strength: chair sit-to-stands, wall push-ups, band rows or light household lifts	Light
Wednesday	Rest or 5-minute gentle mobility break	Light
Thursday	10-minute walk, cycling, swimming, or seated cardio	Light to moderate
Friday	Beginner strength: repeat Tuesday exercises	Light
Saturday	10–15 minutes of enjoyable movement: dancing, gardening, active play, or walking	Light to moderate
Sunday	Rest, stretching, or easy walk	Light

CHAPTER 38

Beginner Strength Example

Complete 1 set of each exercise if comfortable:

5–10 chair sit-to-stands

5–10 wall push-ups

5–10 resistance band rows or towel rows

5–10 heel raises while holding a stable surface

10–20 seconds of gentle core bracing or modified plank, if appropriate

Stop if you feel warning symptoms or unusual pain.

15. Weekly Planning Worksheet

Use this worksheet to create a realistic plan for the next 7 days.

CHAPTER 39

Step 1: Choose Your Main Goal

This week, I want to focus on:

☐ Moving more often

☐ Reducing sitting time

☐ Adding strength twice weekly

☐ Starting with short sessions

☐ Returning after illness, injury, pregnancy, or time away

☐ Building toward the adult weekly guideline

☐ Supporting a child or teen to move more

☐ Other: _____

CHAPTER 40

Step 2: Choose Activities That Fit Your Life

Activities I can realistically do:

Aerobic option:			
Strength			option:
Bone-strengthening	option,	if	appropriate:
Bad-weather			option:
Limited-space			option:
Low-budget			option:

CHAPTER 41

Step 3: Identify Safety Needs

Before I increase activity, I should consider:

- [] Current symptoms
- [] Pain or injury
- [] Pregnancy or postpartum status
- [] Chronic condition
- [] Disability or mobility needs
- [] Medication effects
- [] Balance or fall risk
- [] Need for medical guidance
- [] None of the above

If I have warning symptoms, I will stop and seek medical advice.

CHAPTER 42

Step 4: Build Your Weekly Plan

Day	Aerobic Activity	Strength Activity	Sedentary-Time
Break	Notes or Adaptations		
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			

CHAPTER 43

Step 5: Make It Specific

Complete these sentences:

This week, I will move on these days:

My first strength day will be:

My second strength day will be:

My smallest possible version of the plan is:

If bad weather, low energy, or schedule problems happen, I will:

CHAPTER 44

Step 6: Progress Gradually

Next week, if this plan feels safe and manageable, I may increase:

- ☐ Duration by a small amount
- ☐ Frequency by one additional day
- ☐ Intensity slightly
- ☐ Strength repetitions or resistance slightly
- ☐ Nothing yet; I will repeat the same plan until it feels easier

Remember: increase one part at a time.

16. Mid-Lesson Review

Pause and answer these questions.

CHAPTER 45

Question 1

What is the adult weekly aerobic activity target?

A. 20 minutes per month

- B. 150–300 minutes of moderate activity, or 75–150 minutes of vigorous activity, or a mix
- C. Only vigorous exercise counts
- D. Strength training replaces all aerobic activity

Answer: B

CHAPTER 46

Question 2

How often should most adults do muscle-strengthening activity?

- A. Every day only
- B. At least 2 days per week
- C. Once per month
- D. Never

Answer: B

CHAPTER 47

Question 3

What is the child and adolescent activity target for ages 6–17?

- A. At least 60 minutes per day on average
- B. 10 minutes per week
- C. Only strength training
- D. No vigorous activity

Answer: A

Question 4

Which statement is most accurate?

- A. Activity only counts if it lasts 60 minutes.
- B. Short sessions can add up throughout the week.
- C. Beginners should immediately meet the full guideline.
- D. Sitting time does not matter.

Answer: B

17. Common Barriers and Practical Solutions

Barrier Practical Solution

“I do not have time.” Use 5–10 minute sessions. Add movement to existing routines.

“I cannot afford a gym.” Walk, use stairs, do bodyweight exercises, use free videos, or try resistance bands.

“The weather is bad.” Walk indoors, dance, do chair cardio, or use a low-impact video.

“I have pain.” Choose low-impact options and seek professional guidance if pain is new, severe, or worsening.

“I feel too out of shape.” Start with very short, light sessions. Some activity is better than none.

“I get bored.” Rotate activities, listen to music, invite a friend, or choose active hobbies.

“I sit all day.” Add standing, stretching, or walking breaks every

30–60 minutes.

“I have a chronic condition.” Ask for individualized guidance and choose appropriate intensity and adaptations.

CHAPTER 49

Reflection Prompt

What is your biggest barrier to physical activity right now?

What is one small solution you can try this week?

18. Short Quiz

Choose the best answer.

CHAPTER 50

1. What is the memory formula for this lesson?

- A. Move rarely, strengthen monthly, start hard, progress quickly
- B. Move most days, strengthen twice weekly, start small, progress gradually
- C. Exercise only when motivated
- D. Vigorous activity is the only activity that counts

Answer: B

CHAPTER 51

2. During moderate activity, you can usually:

- A. Talk but not sing
- B. Sing easily
- C. Say only one word before gasping
- D. Not breathe

Answer: A

CHAPTER 52

3. Which is an example of muscle-strengthening activity?

- A. Wall push-ups
- B. Watching TV
- C. Sitting at a desk
- D. Riding in a car

Answer: A

CHAPTER 53

4. Which is an example of bone-strengthening activity for children?

- A. Jumping rope
- B. Lying still
- C. Reading
- D. Sitting in class

Answer: A

CHAPTER 54

5. Which symptom means you should stop activity and seek medical advice?

- A. Chest pain
- B. Normal mild breathing increase during a walk
- C. Feeling warmed up
- D. Sweating lightly during moderate activity

Answer: A

CHAPTER 55

6. Which statement about beginners is most accurate?

- A. They should do intense workouts immediately.
- B. They should start small and progress gradually.
- C. They should avoid all movement until they can do 150 minutes.
- D. Short sessions do not count.

Answer: B

CHAPTER 56

7. Adults should reduce sedentary time by:

- A. Breaking up long periods of sitting when possible
- B. Sitting longer to save energy
- C. Avoiding all movement breaks
- D. Only exercising once per month

Answer: A

CHAPTER 57

8. If your schedule is busy, you can:

- A. Accumulate activity in shorter sessions throughout the week
- B. Give up completely
- C. Only count workouts longer than one hour
- D. Ignore strength activity forever

Answer: A

19. Final Summary

Physical activity is a lifelong health tool, not an all-or-nothing test.

For most adults, the general goal is:

150–300 minutes of moderate aerobic activity per week, or

75–150 minutes of vigorous aerobic activity per week, or

A combination of both

plus

Muscle-strengthening activity at least 2 days per week

For children and adolescents ages 6–17, the general goal is:

At least 60 minutes per day on average

Include vigorous, muscle-strengthening, and bone-strengthening activities at least 3 days per week

Adults should also reduce sedentary time and break up long periods of sitting when possible.

Most importantly:

> Move most days, strengthen twice weekly, start small, progress gradually.

Use the talk test to monitor intensity:

Talk but not sing = moderate

Only a few words = vigorous

Choose activities that fit your life, body, budget, space, weather, and health needs.

Stop activity and seek medical guidance for warning symptoms such as chest pain, severe shortness of breath, fainting, dizziness, irregular heartbeat, unusual severe pain, or symptoms that do not resolve with rest.

20. Your Call to Action

Before you leave this lesson, choose your next step.

Today, I will:

☐ Take a 5–10 minute walk

☐ Do one chair-based movement break

- ☐ Plan two strength days this week
- ☐ Break up sitting time with a short movement break
- ☐ Ask a healthcare professional what activity is safe for me
- ☐ Help a child or teen choose an active game
- ☐ Complete my weekly plan worksheet
- ☐ Other: _____

Write your commitment:

> This week, I will:

>

Then repeat the formula one more time:

> Move most days. Strengthen twice weekly. Start small. Progress gradually.

Source Note

This lesson is grounded in widely used public health guidance from the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans, 2nd edition, and the World Health Organization guidelines on physical activity and sedentary behavior. General guidelines should be adapted to individual health status, symptoms, disability, pregnancy/postpartum needs, injury history, medications, and clinician recommendations.

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